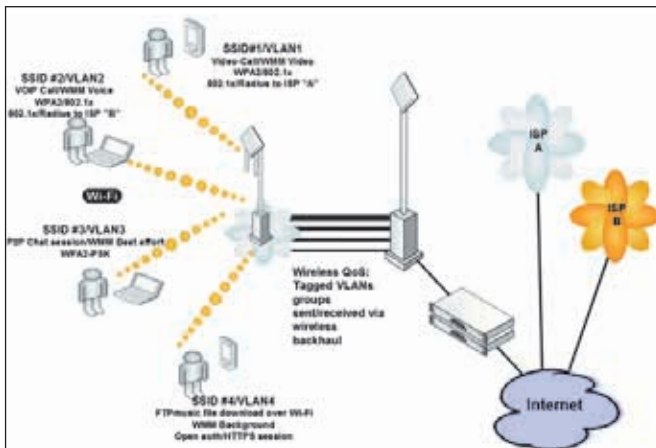


stations that can communicate with each other. The BSS can be understood as two basic types: independent and infrastructure. The independent one is an ad-hoc network that contains no service points. The infrastructure service set communicates with other stations, which though not in the same basic service set, are linked by access points.

An extended service set (ESS) is a set of inter-connected Basic Service Sets (BSSes). Access points in an ESS are connected by a distribution system. A distribution system connects access points across an ESS. Each BSS has an ID called the BSSID which is the MAC ID of the access point and each ESS has an ID called the SSID which is a 32-byte (maximum) character string. Both together allow for identification.

Peer-to-peer: an ad hoc network is a network where stations communicate only peer to peer (P2P). There is no base and no one device gives permission to talk. This is accomplished using the independent basic service set (IBSS). A peer to peer network allows wireless devices to communicate directly with each other. Once two devices are within range of the other, they can communicate independently without any central access points. Once they interact with each other, this initiates the formation of a network.

If a signal strength meter is used in this situation, it may



An example of a network with various devices performing various tasks